



THE MIRACLE MORNING

The Not-So-Obvious Secret Guaranteed to Transform Your Life Before 8am

HAL ELROD



The Big “So What”

Many people dream of an extraordinary life, but end up settling for a mediocre one. **No matter where you are in life—whether you’re struggling to overcome a major setback or ready to move to new heights—this book provides you with a proven method to improve your life and achieve all your dreams and goals.**



Introduction

 When we look at newborn babies, we believe that they can grow up to be whoever and whatever they want to be. Yet, when we grow up, we settle for less than what we want.

- Many people are unhappy with their lives—from their jobs to their weight, finances and relationships. Or, they may excel in 1 area of their life (e.g. career) and settle for mediocrity in other areas. Take a minute to rate each aspect of your life, e.g. love, money, success, health, happiness, and freedom. Are you living at Level 10 in every area of your life?
- Living to your full potential means thriving in every aspect of your life and fulfilling *all* of your goals and dreams. In this book, Elrod shares how he bounced back from death, crippling injuries and career setbacks, and how he used The Miracle Morning (TMM) to unlock his full potential. This approach has been used by thousands of people from all walks of life. No matter how bad your circumstances are, the tips in this book will help you enjoy more energy, vitality, joy, motivation, and productivity. Use them to turn around any area of your life.

KEY QUOTES

“You can become one of the few people that actually live the extraordinary life all of us deserve. Happiness. Health. Money. Freedom. Success. Love. You really can have it all.”

“Know that wherever you are in your life right now is both temporary, and exactly where you are supposed to be.”



In this summary, we'll share about:

- Elrod's personal journey;
- His insights on what it takes to live to your full potential; and
- How to design your Miracle Mornings with the 6 Life S.A.V.E.R.S.



Waking up to your True Potential



You can overcome any obstacle in your life



In 1999, at the age of 20, Elrod had a serious car accident and was clinically dead for several minutes. When he woke up after 6 days in a coma, he was told that he had broken 11 bones, suffered permanent head damage, and may never walk again.

- Elrod was devastated. But he eventually realized that lamenting his tragedy wouldn't change anything. He decided to embrace his new reality and make the best of his situation instead.
- As he recuperated, Elrod returned to his sales job. By 2005, he had moved up into a managerial role and was leading a top sales team. Yet, he was still far from realizing his full potential. That year, he made a firm commitment to double his sales and finish writing the book that he had been putting off. He achieved both his goals. The book made it to Amazon's bestseller list, but unfortunately, his publisher ran away with the royalties. Still, Elrod remained unfrazzled, believing he could turn any trial into triumph.



Yet, when the US economy crashed in 2007, Elrod finally fell into despair. By then, he had successfully made the leap into professional coaching (something he truly loved). His business collapsed during the crisis and he was laden with \$425,000 debt. Unlike the car accident (when he was surrounded by love and support), this time he was on his own since

KEY QUOTES

"Even when life is difficult or challenging—especially when life is difficult and challenging—the present is always an opportunity for us to learn, grow, and become better than we've ever been before."

"Everything happens for a reason...it is our responsibility to choose the most empowering reasons for the challenges, events and circumstances of our lives."

"Anything is possible when you're committed."

everyone was struggling with their own problems. After 9 years of rebuilding his life and successes, he had fallen once again into mental, emotional and financial ruin. Elrod lost all hope. He struggled to get out of bed each morning and even contemplated suicide.



His turning point came in 2008, when he took his friend's advice to go for a morning run.

- As he ran, he listened to a personal development audio by Jim Rohn, and a message clicked home. **Elrod realized that he wanted Level 10 successes, but had been unable to achieve them because his own personal development was only at Level 3 or 4.** There was a huge potential gap between where he was and where he could be.
- He decided to devote an hour each morning to develop himself, and the results were so amazing that he coined it The Miracle Morning (TMM). Soon, he was sharing TMM with his coaching clients, who in turn shared it with their friends. TMM has since become a global movement as people awakened to its life-changing impact.



Getting to the top 5%

One of the hardest things to do is to overcome our own excuses. This is why only 5% of people gain financial success and freedom, while the large majority struggle their entire lives.



95% of people will stay average. Every one of us is worthy of phenomenal success. Yet, the average person isn't willing to take responsibility for his life and consistently do the things he knows he should. Sadly, this 95% will include most of your friends and family. But when you live to your full potential, you'll naturally create positive ripple effects on those around you.



Know what it takes to overcome mediocrity:

- We wrongly assume that our past defines who we are and what we can achieve in the future. We set artificial limits by telling ourselves "I can't do this", "I've never tried that", or "I'm not that kind of person". Elrod calls this the

KEY QUOTES

"There is no point in dwelling on or feeling bad about the aspects of our lives that we can't change. By focusing on what we can learn from our challenges and how we use them to add value to the lives of others, we can turn any adversity into an advantage."

"Being average means to settle for less than you truly want and are capable of, and to struggle for your entire life."

"We all know what we need to do; we just don't consistently do what we know."

"Where you are is a result of who you were, but where you go depends entirely on who you choose to be, from this moment on."

"Rearview Mirror Syndrome" (RMS). Remember: your past doesn't define your future. You can achieve *anything* if you truly commit to it.

- Most people lack a higher purpose in life. They're simply surviving each day, doing whatever gives them the most short-term pleasure or the least pain. If you don't know your purpose yet, just start by picking any purpose (e.g. to help 5 people daily, or to become the best version of yourself). As you grow and change, your purpose will likewise evolve.
- Don't dismiss your daily actions and decisions as isolated one-off events. In reality, everything you do (or don't do) matters. When you skip a workout, take a shortcut, or press the snooze button, it all adds up to define who you become, which in turn decides the life you'll have.
- Accountability is about making yourself responsible to someone, so you'll take action even if you don't feel like it. Every successful person practices accountability. Without it, you'll simply end up on the path of least resistance. Get an accountability partner, e.g. a friend, colleague, family member or someone from The Miracle Morning Community (MyTMMCommunity.com).
- You become the average of the 5 people you spend the most time with. If you're surrounded by positive, motivated achievers, it'll rub off on you. The same happens if you're surrounded by negative, lazy people. Keep elevating your circle of influence. Proactively seek out people who bring out the best in you and can help you to achieve your goals. Add value back to them in return.
- According to Jim Rohn, your level of success can never exceed your level of personal development. Who you are on the inside (including your beliefs, perspectives and attitudes) decides how you think and act, and thus the results you achieve. In short, your outer world is a reflection of your inner world. Define what your Level 10 life—be it physical, intellectual, emotional and spiritual—should look like, then keep working toward it.
- Don't procrastinate. Inject a sense of urgency and start now.

KEY QUOTES

"Focus on growing and being the best you can be, pursuing your dreams and inspiring others to do the same. That's your purpose."

"Who you're becoming is far more important than what you're doing, and yet it is what you're doing that is determining who you're becoming."

"It is often said that 'misery loves company', but so does mediocrity. Don't let the fears, insecurities, and limiting beliefs of others limit what's possible for you."

"Our levels of success will rarely exceed our level of personal development, because success is something we attract by who we become."



Make a firm decision to live your life differently. **Ultimately, the difference between excellence and mediocrity is what you do each day to improve yourself.**

- Stop settling for less and start devoting time daily to make things happen. Make that commitment today.
- Like most people, you may be thinking, "I have no time". Well, your life is much more than your current circumstances. If you continue in survival mode, you'll just keep struggling. Alternatively, you can decide to create time: commit to wake up 1 hour earlier and devote that time to develop yourself for success.



The Power of Waking Up Right



How you wake up and start your day has a disproportionate impact on how the rest of your day unfolds. To wake up right:

- Don't snooze your alarm. That sends the signal that you don't want to wake up, and you begin your day with resistance. When you wake up purposefully with a bounce in your step, it'll set an entirely different tone for your day.
- Manage your energy levels, not your sleep hours. Elrod found that the number of hours he slept mattered less than his expectations of how he'd feel. If he went to bed thinking he'd be tired in the morning, he'd feel tired even with 8-9 hours of sleep. But, if he told himself he'd wake up feeling energized, he'd feel revitalized even if he slept just 5 hours.



Use this 5-step strategy to wake up without snoozing:

- Set the right intentions before you sleep. Often, your last thought at night is the first thing you remember in the morning. Use the free Bedtime Affirmation from TMMBook.com to condition your mind, so you'll wake up feeling fresh and energized.
- Place your alarm clock far from the bed, so you're forced to get up and move. This generates energy to wake you up.

KEY QUOTES

"Today you can draw your line in the sand. You can decide that mediocrity is no longer acceptable for you...You can choose to become the person you need to be to create the extraordinary life that you truly want."

"The tone of our morning has a powerful impact on the tone of the rest of our day."

"Waking up early, especially when done with purpose, always starts you off feeling empowered for your day."

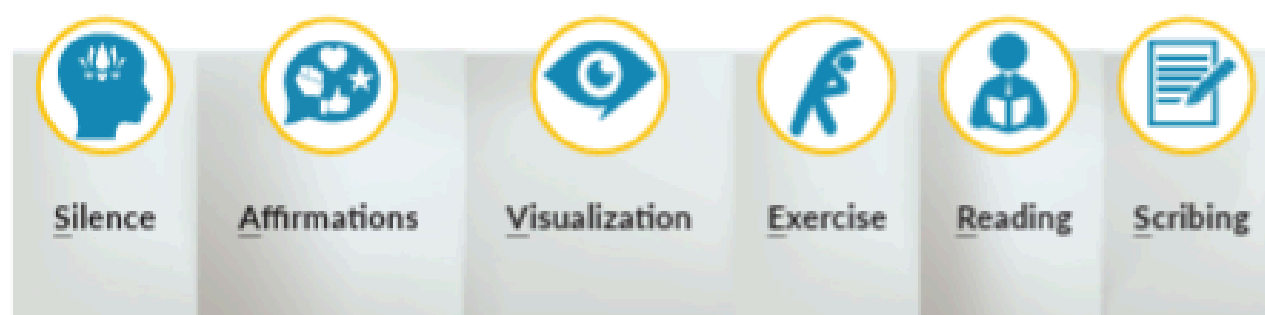
- Once you've turned off your alarm, go straight to the bathroom and brush your teeth. Splash some water on your face.
- Drink a full glass of water to hydrate and energize yourself.
- Take a shower or get dressed.



The Miracle Morning: 6 Life S.A.V.E.R.S. Practices

The Miracle Morning is simply about waking up an hour earlier and devoting that time to develop yourself. Use the 6 Life S.A.V.E.R.S. to transform your inner world, and you'll automatically transform your external circumstances. This approach works for everyone, regardless of your schedule or whether you're a "morning person". You can set aside 10mins for each component, or customize the routine according to your lifestyle and goals.

THE 6 LIFE S.A.V.E.R.S



Practice #1: Silence



Start your morning with purposeful Silence: center yourself and create an optimum frame of mind to face the rest of your day. When you deliberately silence your mind, it creates many health and performance benefits, from stress reduction to better concentration and metabolism. It also improves self-awareness and clarity. Instead of feeling hectic, stressed or lethargic, you'll find yourself feeling calm, peaceful and rejuvenated.

KEY QUOTES

"Our outer world will always be a reflection of our inner world. Our level of success is always going to parallel our level of personal development."

*"You can learn more in an hour of silence than you can in a year from books."
—Matthew Kelly*

- Elrod personally combines several components for this practice: meditation, prayer, reflection, deep breathing and gratitude. You can mix and match them as you wish.
- There are 2 types of meditations: (i) guided meditations (where you direct your focus by listening to someone's instructions) and (ii) self meditations (where you do it alone without assistance).

»» Here are the suggested steps for your Miracle Morning meditation:

- Prepare yourself mentally. Be fully present in the now, letting go of your worries of the past or future. Allow yourself to just "be", without the compulsive need to think or do something.
- Find a quiet and comfortable location. Don't do this in bed. Ideally, have a place outside your bedroom (e.g. your living room sofa) that you can use every morning.
- Sit upright and cross-legged. You can use a chair or pillow for extra comfort. Close your eyes or focus on the ground 2ft ahead.
- Focus on your breathing. Breathe slowly and deeply into your belly (not your chest). Inhale from your nose for 3 seconds, hold it for 3 seconds, then exhale from your mouth for 3 seconds. If any thoughts pop up, just acknowledge them, let them go, and refocus on your breathing.
- Enjoy this time with yourself. You can imagine inhaling soothing, positive energy, and exhaling stressful, negative energy. You can also incorporate words of what you'd like to receive from or give to the world e.g. "I breathe in love... I breathe out peace."



Practice #2: Affirmations



All of us have certain sub-conscious programming that shapes what we believe, think, feel and act. This is often reflected in the non-stop chatter in your head. Your self-talk—both

KEY QUOTES

"Think of daily meditation as a temporary vacation from your problems. While your problems will still be there... you'll find that you are much more centered and better equipped to solve them."

positive and negative—has a huge impact on your state of mind, performance and results.

- Successful people make a conscious effort to manage that inner voice. They use affirmations to shape their mindset. When you tell yourself “There’s nothing I can do” or “This is beyond me”, you feel and act differently from when you tell yourself “I am in control of my destiny!” or “I’m committed to do whatever it takes to make things happen!”
- For years after his car accident, Elrod told himself that his memory was bad due to his brain damage. Yet, after a period of daily affirmations, his memory actually improved. His affirmation went like this: “I am letting go of the limiting belief that I have a horrible memory. My brain is a miraculous organism capable of healing itself, and my memory can improve, but only in proportion to how much I believe it can improve. So, from this moment on, I am maintaining the unwavering belief that I have an excellent memory, and it’s continuing to get better every day.”



You can use affirmations to re-program yourself to become who you want to be—to be healthier, wealthier, be great with people etc. Design your affirmations according to your goals. Write them out explicitly and read them daily, ideally out loud. You must repeat it until your subconscious mind starts to believe it and triggers action to make it a reality.

➤➤➤ Create your affirmations with these 5 steps:

- Get clear on what you truly want. Start by writing down your ideal vision for every aspect of your life, including your relationships, finances, physical, mental and emotional health.
- Understand why you want what you want, i.e. what’s driving you. A clear life purpose helps you to rise above petty daily issues.
- Define the kind of person you must become in order to achieve your goals (e.g. determined, confident, teachable).
- Define what you’re committed to do to achieve your goals. Be specific: indicate the frequency, quantity, and duration of your actions, e.g. “I am 100% committed to run for

KEY QUOTES

“It’s the repetition of affirmations that leads to belief. Once that belief becomes a deep conviction, things begin to happen.”
—Muhammad Ali

“Your life gets better only after you get better....Being (who you need to be) and doing (what you need to do) are prerequisites for having what you want to have.”

20 min in the park 2 days a week". Start small, so you'll feel good about completing the actions, then gradually increase them over time.

- Write down inspiring quotes or ideas so you can progressively integrate them into your affirmations.

 Here are some additional tips on affirmations:

- Affirmations are the most effective when you connect them with your emotions and physiology, i.e. you connect your mind, heart and body. Tune in to feelings of hope, love, or excitement. Shout out loud or even dance around.
- Read your affirmations daily and update them as you evolve.



Practice #3: Visualizations



Visualizations are about imagining certain activities or outcomes in your mind, and mentally rehearsing them until you can create those results in the real world. They're regularly used by athletes and successful people, including Tiger Woods, Tony Robbins, Will Smith, and Bill Gates. Daily visualizations align your thoughts and feelings with your vision, help you to overcome self-limiting beliefs and habits, and thus increase your likelihood of taking the actions to make the vision a reality.



You can apply this 3-step process for your Miracle Morning visualization, straight after reading your affirmations.

- Prepare by sitting upright and comfortably. You can play soft background music if you wish. Take slow/deep breaths, close your eyes and still your mind.
- Visualize what success looks and feels like to you. Create a crystal-clear picture of exactly what you want. What would life be like if you could truly have anything you wanted? Use all your senses to see, hear, feel, smell and sense every tiny detail in your vision—experience what it's like to have achieved your goals.

KEY QUOTES

"See things as you would have them be instead of as they are."
—Robert Collier

- Visualize the person you must become and what you must do. Imagine yourself taking the necessary actions to achieve your vision. See yourself doing those things with ease, passion and confidence, smiling and enjoying what you do. Visualize positive responses from your family, friends and colleagues.

 Here are some additional tips on visualization:

- The more viscerally you can see what you want, the more effective your visualizations will be.
- You can also create a vision board with pictures of your ideal life. But remember: there can be no results without action.



Practice #4: Exercise



Exercise is crucial for your health, well-being and productivity. Even a few minutes of exercise each morning can significantly improve your energy levels, health and concentration.



Choose the form of exercise that works for you, be it walking, running, doing jumping jacks etc. Elrod recommends yoga, which combines cardio with strength, flexibility and focused breathing.



Practice #5: Reading



Reading is one of the fastest ways to learn from people who've already achieved what you aspire to achieve. No matter what aspect of your life you wish to improve—be it wealth, relationships or career—there are great books that can teach you exactly how to achieve results.



Fill your mind with positive inputs. Elrod recommends reading a minimum of 10-15 minutes a day (or about 10 pages). You can also use your Miracle Morning to read your religious texts.

KEY QUOTES

*"Vision boards are for dreaming, action boards are for achieving."
—Neil Farber*

"The fastest way to achieve everything you want is to model successful people who have already achieved it."

*"Reading is to the mind what exercise is to the body and prayer is to the soul. We become the books we read."
—Matthew Kelly*



If you don't like reading, remind yourself *why* you're reading that book. Highlight, underline, circle and make notes as you read. Make it a point to re-read, apply and master good strategies that you've learned.



Practice #6: Scribing



Make it a daily habit to document your ideas, insights, achievements, breakthroughs or opportunities. Journaling helps you direct your thoughts consciously and put them in writing. This creates several benefits:

- Often, the very act of writing down something forces you gain clarity and think differently about a problem;
- It allows you to capture and expand on your ideas; and
- When you review your progress and lessons learned, it helps to accelerate your personal growth.



Use these 3 steps to journal more effectively:

- Choose between a digital format (typing digitally) or traditional format (writing by hand), based on your personal preferences.
- Get your journal. You can download digital apps, including the TMM Journal. For traditional journals, go for something that's lined and dated, so you have space to write for 365 days.
- Decide what to write, e.g. your goals, plans, gratitude entries, accomplishments, areas of improvement, commitments, and reflections.



Review your journal at least once per year. It helps you to revisit your thoughts and actions for the past year so you can see how much you have grown and accomplished.

- To gain the most from your reviews, list down:
 - (i) People, events and lessons that you're grateful for;

KEY QUOTES

"Ideas can come from anywhere and at any time. The problem with making mental notes is that the ink fades very rapidly."
—Rolf Smith

"By getting your thoughts out of your head and putting them in writing, you gain valuable insights you'd otherwise never see."

- (ii) Key lessons you've learned; and
- (iii) New commitments you'd make to apply those lessons.
- To stay motivated, adopt a balanced perspective of your potential gap:
 - (i) Celebrate your progress, accomplishments, and the things you're grateful for; and
 - (ii) Identify the key lessons learned and commit to apply them so you can steepen your learning curve.



Installing your Miracle Morning Habit



Customize your routine



You're free to tailor and optimize your routine any way you like:

- Adjust your start-time according to your work schedule. If you're on shift-work, just wake up 30-60 min earlier than usual each day.
- Ideally, drink a full glass of water first thing in the morning, then eat *after* your Miracle Morning. Go for living foods (e.g. fresh vegetables and fruits) if possible.
- Align your routine with your goals and dreams. If your priority is to finish writing your book, then link your affirmations and visualizations to the ease, enjoyment and satisfaction of writing and finishing your book. Always do the hardest things first to get them out of the way.
- Test different variations to see what works best for you. Try doing the Miracle Morning daily vs taking the weekend off to rest. You can also allocate more time for certain practices (e.g. reading/exercise) relative to others. Modify your routine to keep things fresh or as your goals evolve.

KEY QUOTES

"Whether you realize it or not, your life has been, and will continue to be, created by your habits. If you don't control your habits, your habits will control you."



The key is to be consistent. Even on days when you're very busy, you can still do a compressed 6-minute Miracle Morning, with 1 minute for each Life S.A.V.E.R.S. practice.



Build Life-Transforming Habits in 30 Days



Human beings are creatures of habit, and old habits are hard to break. According to different experts, habits-formation can happen any time between 1 day (via hypnosis) to 21 or 90 days. **Based on Elrod's experience with his clients, 30 days is a good duration for develop your Miracle Morning habit.** The key is to have a proper strategy for installing the habit:

- Phase 1 (Days 1-10): Intolerable. The initial period will feel unbearable, but it's temporary and will pass.
- Phase 2 (Days 11-20): Uncomfortable. The next 10 days will be easier, but you'll still need discipline to push past the discomfort.
- Phase 3 (Days 21-30): Unstoppable. These last 10 days are vital for reinforcing and sustaining the new habit. This is when you start to associate positive feelings (pride, satisfaction) with the habit, and shift from hating it to enjoying it. The real transformation happens when you see the habit as a part of your identity or who you're becoming.



Use The Miracle Morning 30-Day Life Transformation Challenge (LTC) to install your new habit. Download the free LTC Fast Start Kit from TMMbook.com and follow the instructions there.



Thousands of people have transformed their lives with TMM, and so can you. The key is to start now. Don't wait. Get an accountability partner *immediately* to ensure you follow up on your commitment.

KEY QUOTES

"In the next 30 days you'll find yourself quickly becoming the person you need to be to create the extraordinary levels of personal, professional, and financial success you truly desire."

"Everything is difficult before it's easy. Every new experience is uncomfortable before it's comfortable."